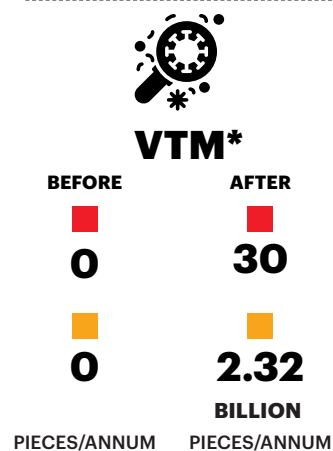
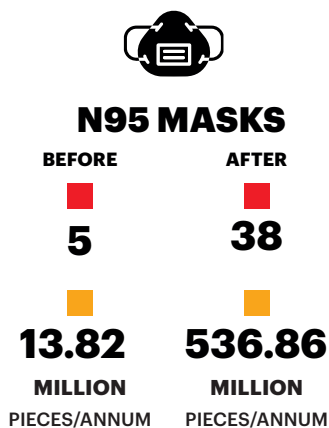
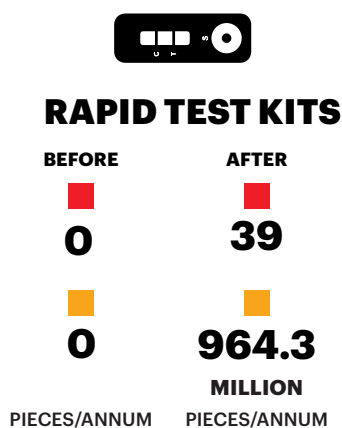
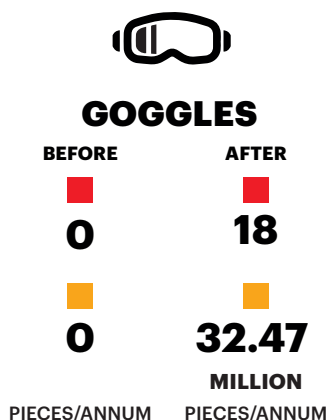
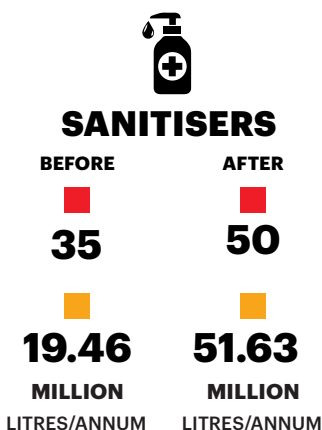


■ Total number of manufacturers ■ Total manufacturing capacity; data as of January 13, 2022

*viral transport media, used to carry samples; **Source:** Association of Indian Medical Device Industry

says CEO and Founder Ashok Patel.

Besides these, almost all diagnostic companies came out with some form of Covid-19 test kits or other. Now, some that had invested in Covid-19 test kits are looking at other markets for exports. For example, Mylab Discovery Solutions, which makes Covid-19 test kits along with other diagnostic products, is looking at international markets that have demand for such kits, says MD Hasmukh Rawal. The company had a 30,000 sq. ft facility, and the necessary approvals to manufacture critical molecular diagnostic products before the pandemic. When Covid-19 struck, Mylab “decided to redirect our resources to make Covid-19 test kits”. Now, it is focussing on other diseases. “We have invested around \$15 million in our manufacturing facility,” adds Rawal.

According to health industry experts, an estimated 20,000 oxygen concentrators are lying unsold or unused. As a majority of Indians are vaccinated against Covid-19 and the infections are mild, the surplus items, experts say, can have other use cases. “We have close to 25,000 primary health centres (PHCs) in rural areas. The government can consider moving simpler equipment and devices like oxygen concentrators to PHCs and community health centres in rural areas that can act as first-level treatment for the patients,” says Medikabazaar’s Tiwari.

Agrees Dr Rana Mehta, Healthcare Industry Leader and Partner at PwC India: “With the demand for these products going down due to lower incidence of coronavirus cases, these manufacturers need to reinvent these products as the opportunity for growth of hospitals is clearly visible. Repurposing these products for larger healthcare needs is required for the twin purpose of usage of the unused products, and boosting the healthcare sector.” Policy support and special duty waivers to facilitate the export of unused equipment could also help, say experts. Medical device manufacturers stuck with unsold Covid-19 inventory would be hoping that some of these suggestions come good. **BT**

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